

Not Mine

Microsoft plans to do away with the 'My' prefix in Longhorn. Longhorn will have just 'Documents', 'Music' and so on as folder names. The longstanding tradition of naming the folders with the 'My' prefix was an attempt to create a personal connection between people and their computers.



Funding For Linux-Based OS

A British company, Netproject, will develop a secure Linux-based desktop OS. The British Department of Trade and Industry has contributed £132,000 (Rs 1.04 crore) to the Secure Open Source Desktop programme. A similar sum has been donated by members of Netproject's Incubator Club.



Enter

Boman Irani
Actor

Boman Irani has done it all—fashion photography, theatre and Bollywood. The veteran actor's take on technology:

What does technology mean to you?

Whether we like it or not, technology is all-pervasive in our lives today—from the kitchen to the home entertainment system. One simply can't deny the role it plays in our daily lives.

Where do you use technology the most?

As a professional, you need to stay connected, and the mobile phone is like a lifeline. While I cannot answer each and every call, callers can at least reach me through SMS so I can get back to them later.

Do you own other gadgets?

I am not a gadget freak, but I have a camera phone. I use the camera feature often—more so when I am in a certain get-up, and I would like to store that image for some other occasion to show it to my make-up man.

How often do you surf?

I travel extensively, and surf the Internet primarily to look for holiday destinations.

An instance where technology has saved lives?

Undoubtedly, modern medicine. Surgery is now less painful and far quicker thanks to advancements in technology. Why, you see people who have undergone major surgery walking the very next day!

PIECE OF THE PIE

Intel To Get Inside Apple

Apple's decision to use Intel microprocessors and dump IBM's PowerPC chip is the biggest piece of news in the tech world this month. While the move may not have much of an impact on Intel's bottomline, given the fact that the Mac has just over two per cent of the world's desktop marketshare, it will definitely be a big boost to the troubled chip maker.

The Apple Mac is viewed as the über-cool of the computer world, and an alliance with them will help leverage Intel's position in the microprocessor market. The move will also help Apple address key portability issues that has plagued it in the past.

At a keynote address announcing the PowerPC-to-Intel transition, Apple CEO Steve Jobs revealed that Apple and Intel will provide developers with tools to help port code from the existing chip architecture to the new one.

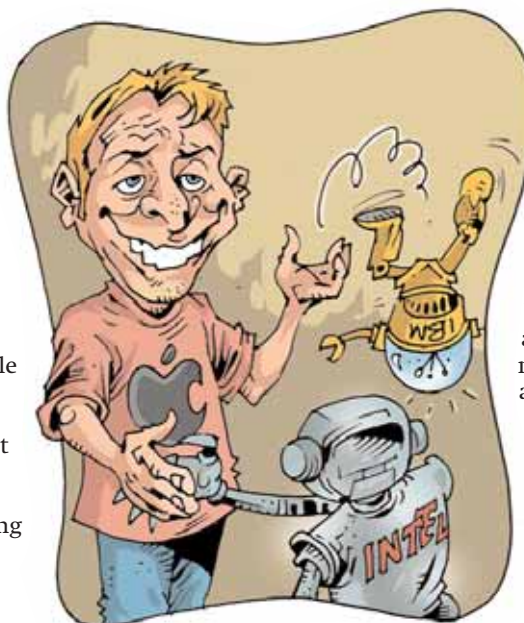
Apple said it was making the move to x86 architecture chips because of more power and better stability. But according to experts, one of the main reasons behind the switch is IBM's inability to develop versions of the G5 chip,

used in Apple's desktop G5 machines, which are suitable for Apple laptops without overheating. Applications will continue to work on both types of chipsets for some years.

Analysts, though, are seeing this move as a means to creating confusion in the minds of consumers. Some analysts have suggested that the transition

most innovative personal computer company as a customer," said Paul Otellini, President and CEO of Intel. "Apple helped found the PC industry and throughout the years has been known for fresh ideas and new approaches. We look forward to providing advanced chip technologies, and to collaborating on new initiatives, to help Apple continue to deliver innovative products for years to come."

Apple has used IBM's PowerPC processors since 1994. It plans to move lower-end computers such as the Mac Mini to Intel chips in mid-2006, and higher-end models such as the Power Mac in mid-2007. Reports about a project that maintained parallel Apple OSes that worked on x86 architecture—codenamed *Marklar*—are surfacing and, if true, would mean that the transition will be easier than expected.



could further damage Apple's low 2.3 per cent global market share, while others argue that this is a logical decision. Resistance is also expected from the Mac fanatic—the hardcore user of Macs and Apple Corp. would need to work overtime to ward this off.

Market analysts largely feel this will help Apple more than Intel. "We are thrilled to have the world's

HERE, LINUX!

Puppy Linux For Your PC

A retired lecturer from Australia has come up with the latest morph of Linux, a distribution of the Open Source OS that takes little memory and can